



Gastro & Concept Development

March 19 – 31, 2026

PART 1 — THE CONCEPT (March 19 – 22)

01

How You Make a Location Stand Out From Day One

When you look at a new space — what is the move that makes it impossible to ignore? Not just 'nice interior' or 'good food' — what is the thing that makes someone walk past, stop, and come back? Walk through how you think about making a location feel like it already belongs in the neighbourhood, even when it is brand new. What creates that immediate pull?

Think about the details that most operators never even consider.

02

What Separates a Good Concept From a Great One

You have seen a lot of concepts — some that work immediately, some that take time, some that never quite click. In your experience: what is the difference between a concept that becomes a regular spot people recommend and one that just exists? Is it the idea itself, the execution, the positioning, the timing — or something else entirely? Write about what you have observed across your own locations and others.

This is the kind of knowledge that takes years to develop and cannot be Googled.

03

How a Location Can Outperform Its Neighbourhood

Some locations punch way above their weight — they draw people from across the city, command higher prices than anyone nearby, and always seem full even when similar places around them struggle. What makes that happen? From what you have seen and built: what are the levers that let a location outperform everything around it — not just survive, but dominate its category?

Think about the locations you admire most, and what they do that others copy but never quite replicate.

04

The Decisions That Define Whether a Location Thrives or Just Gets By

Looking at your four locations: there were moments where a decision — maybe one nobody else noticed — made a big difference to how things developed. What were those moments? What did you choose, and why? And looking back: what are the decisions you now know are the most important ones to get right early?

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CHECKPOINT CALLS

Call 1 · Tue Mar 25 Walk through Part 1 — what is solid, what needs more depth

05

From Empty Space to Opening Night — How You Do It

Walk through the full process from signing a lease to first service. What happens in what order, and why in that order? Where do most people lose time or momentum — and how do you avoid that? Think of this as the director's cut: the version with all the decisions visible, not just the finished result.

Include the things that are second nature to you — those are exactly what others would miss.

06

The Supplier and Partner Network That Makes It All Work

Behind every good location is a network of people who deliver when it counts. Write down the suppliers, partners, and contacts that you rely on — the Italian product connections, the POS people, the contractors who show up, anyone you call when something needs to happen fast. For each: what they do, how long you have worked with them, and why you trust them.

This network took years to build. On paper, it becomes one of MOF's most valuable assets.

07

The Concepts You Could Deploy Today — and Who They Are For

If a client came to us tomorrow with a great space and an open mind — what would be on the shortlist of concepts you could build for them right now? Walk through each one: what kind of location does it need, who is the customer, what makes it work, and where have you seen it work best? Think of this as a menu of options — not a fixed product catalogue.

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08

The Moments That Taught You the Most

Every great operator has moments where something unexpected happened — and the way they handled it is what set them apart. Write about two or three of those moments from your own locations: what the situation was, what you did, and what you understand now that you did not understand before. These stories are the most powerful thing we can put in front of a future client.

Real stories build trust faster than any credentials. These are gold.

CHECKPOINT CALLS

Call 2 · Thu Mar 27 Review concept catalogue — align with what M and F need

09

Four Locations, Four Stories — Written to Inspire

Write a short story for each of your four locations. Not a report — a story. Where it started, what you saw in it that others might have missed, what you built and why, and what it became. These are the case studies that go on the website and into client conversations. Write them the way you would tell them over a good dinner.

Someone should read this and immediately think: I want this person working on my location.

10

The April Location Briefs — What We Are Going in to Achieve

For each of the five locations we are visiting in April: write a short brief. What is already working? What is the one thing that could make it significantly better? And what do you want M and F to focus on when we are there? This becomes M's shooting direction and F's sales angle for each location.

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DELIVERABLES

✓ What makes a location stand out — written	Mar 22
✓ Good concept vs great concept — your take	Mar 22
✓ How a location outperforms its neighbourhood	Mar 23
✓ The decisions that define early success	Mar 24
✓ Week-by-week process from signing to opening	Mar 25
✓ Supplier and partner network — documented	Mar 26
✓ Concept catalogue — options you can deploy today	Mar 26
✓ 2–3 stories from the field — moments that taught you	Mar 27
✓ 4 × location stories — written to inspire	Mar 29
✓ 5 × April location briefs	Mar 31

CHECKPOINT CALLS

Call 1 · Tue Mar 25

Part 1 review

Call 2 · Thu Mar 27

Part 2 review + concept catalogue alignment

Final Call · Mon Mar 31

All docs done — April shoots confirmed